IS101 — Introduction to Computing

IT Help Desk Operations Manual

College of Southern Nevada · Unit 2 — Word Processing · Project 5 · 100 points · 14 tasks

How to use this document: Download the starter file from the Project Grader, open it in Microsoft Word 365, and keep this sheet open beside it. Work through each task in order. Each task tells you what to do, why it matters, and where to find the tool — but you figure out the exact steps yourself. That's the learning. When you're done, save the file and upload it to the grader for instant scoring.

D1 — Page Setup & Document Design 31 points · 6 tasks

Task 1 5 points

Apply a light blue page color to the document

WHY THIS MATTERS

A subtle background color gives the manual a polished, branded look and helps distinguish it from plain documents.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Design tab → Page Background group → Page Color → choose a light blue shade.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Every page has a light blue background tint.

Task 2 5 points

Add a box border around the entire document

WHY THIS MATTERS

Page borders frame each page and give the manual a finished, professional appearance.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Design tab → Page Background group → Page Borders → Box → choose a style → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Every page has a visible border around all four edges.

Task 3 8 points

Insert a hyperlink on “support portal” in the Introduction

WHY THIS MATTERS

Hyperlinks let readers click directly to the IT Help Desk website instead of typing the URL manually. In the Introduction section, find the sentence that says “visit the support portal (link to be added)” — select the words “support portal” and add the hyperlink there.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the words “support portal” in the Introduction → Insert tab → Links group → Link → paste or type the CSN IT Help Desk URL → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The text “support portal” appears as blue underlined text; Ctrl+click opens the URL.

Task 4 5 points

Insert a degree symbol (°) in the Fahrenheit troubleshooting note

WHY THIS MATTERS

Special symbols like the degree sign (°) cannot be typed directly from the keyboard. The FAQ section has a question about laptop overheating — find “below 95” and insert the degree symbol between “95” and “F” so it reads “95°F.”

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click between “95” and “F” → Insert tab → Symbols group → Symbol → More Symbols → find the degree sign (°) → Insert.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The text reads “95°F” with the degree symbol visible between the number and the letter.

Task 5 8 points

Format the FAQ section in two columns with a column break

WHY THIS MATTERS

Two-column layout fits more Q&A pairs on a page and is easy to scan. A column break controls exactly where the second column starts. First, select the FAQ section and format it as two columns. Then insert a column break after the second Q&A pair so the third question starts at the top of the right column.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the FAQ text → Layout tab → Columns → Two. Then click after the second Q&A answer → Layout tab → Breaks → Column.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The FAQ flows into two columns, with Q3 starting at the top of the right column.

Task 6 9 points

Set the FAQ section to 0.75-inch margins

WHY THIS MATTERS

Narrower margins on a reference section give more room for content. Since different margins apply only to a specific section, you need a section break before the FAQ first. Insert a section break, then change the margins for that section only.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click before the FAQ heading → Layout tab → Breaks → Next Page (to create a new section). Then with the cursor in the FAQ section → Layout tab → Margins → Custom Margins → set all margins to 0.75" → Apply to: This section → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The FAQ section has visibly narrower margins than the rest of the document. The Margins dialog shows 0.75" when clicked in the FAQ section.

D2 — Table Management 44 points · 6 tasks

Task 7 9 points

Convert the Ticket Priority List to a table

WHY THIS MATTERS

The Ticket Priority List is currently plain text with tabs between each item. Converting it to a table makes the data easier to read, sort, and format. The list has three columns: Priority, Description, and Response Time.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select all the Ticket Priority List text (from “Priority” through the last row “General how-to question”) → Insert tab → Table group → Convert Text to Table → in the dialog, select Tabs as the separator → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The ticket priority data appears in a clean 3-column table. Clicking in it shows the Table Layout tab.

Task 8 8 points

Convert the Software Version table back to plain text

WHY THIS MATTERS

Sometimes a table is no longer needed in table format. The outdated Software Version table should be converted back to plain text. Look for the table that lists software like “Microsoft Office,” “Adobe Creative Cloud,” etc.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click anywhere in the Software Version table → Table Layout tab → Data group → Convert to Text → select Tabs → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The software version data appears as plain tab-separated text, no longer inside a table grid.

Task 9 5 points

Increase cell margins on the Equipment table

WHY THIS MATTERS

Wider cell margins add breathing room inside table cells, making the data easier to read. Apply this to the Equipment Loan table (the one listing Laptop, Webcam, etc.).

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click anywhere in the Equipment table → Table Layout tab → Alignment group → Cell Margins → increase the Top and Bottom margins (try 0.08" or higher) → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The text inside each cell has more space around it compared to before.

Task 10 8 points

Split the merged header cell in the Ticket table

WHY THIS MATTERS

The Ticket Information table has a merged cell in the header row. Split it back into individual columns so each column has its own header. Look for the table with “Ticket #1001” and “Ticket #1002.”

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click in the merged header cell → Table Layout tab → Merge group → Split Cells → set the number of columns to 2 → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

The header row now has two separate cells instead of one merged cell.

Task 11 5 points

Resize the Equipment table columns to fit content

WHY THIS MATTERS

Auto-fitting columns removes wasted space and makes each column only as wide as its content needs.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click anywhere in the Equipment table → Table Layout tab → Cell Size group → AutoFit → AutoFit Contents.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Columns shrink or expand to fit their content snugly.

Task 12 9 points

Split the Software Inventory table into two separate tables

WHY THIS MATTERS

When a table is too long, splitting it into two makes each section easier to manage. The Software Inventory table (listing software with License Type) should be split into two tables at a logical midpoint.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Click in a row near the middle of the Software Inventory table → Table Layout tab → Merge group → Split Table.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Two separate tables appear where there was one. A paragraph mark separates them.

D3 — Advanced Elements 16 points · 2 tasks

Task 13 8 points

Apply a checkmark bullet to the Quick-Fix List

WHY THIS MATTERS

Custom bullet characters make certain lists stand out. The Quick-Fix List of common solutions should use a checkmark (✓) instead of a standard round bullet.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Select the Quick-Fix List items → Home tab → Paragraph group → Bullets dropdown → Define New Bullet → Symbol → change the font to Wingdings → select the checkmark character → OK.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

Each quick-fix item has a checkmark (✓) instead of a round bullet.

Task 14 8 points

Insert a rounded rectangle shape to highlight the Emergency Contact box

WHY THIS MATTERS

Shapes draw attention to critical information. A rounded rectangle around the emergency contact details makes them impossible to miss.

WHERE TO FIND IT

Insert tab → Illustrations group → Shapes → Rounded Rectangle → draw the shape over the emergency contact information.

HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED

A rounded rectangle shape appears around or near the emergency contact details.

Total: 100 points. Every task on this sheet is graded automatically when you upload your file. © Dr. Mark Taormino · All Rights Reserved · College of Southern Nevada